Muswell Hill and Fortis Green, London N10

This El Niño probably won't bring a deep freeze to Muswell Hill. The danger here is the ordinary winter: flu and RSV, in the oldest corner of Haringey, among people who live alone in large, cold, solid-walled houses. Many of them are asset-rich and income-poor, and they would never call themselves vulnerable. The most lives are saved by getting RSV and flu jabs to everyone over 75 before December, by getting money they are owed into their hands, and by keeping a named neighbour in touch through the cold spells. Rushed wall insulation this autumn would do more harm than good.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
The Climate Impact Lab region containing the London Borough of Haringey (about 260,000 people, roughly one region; region name not resolved). N10 sits on its western edge, with a strip in the	No figure published for the UK or Europe	Jun 2026 – Feb 2027 (heat only; not this hazard)	Flu, RSV, and cold homes in ordinary cold weeks; short cold spells; burst water mains in the thaw; storm-felled trees; surface-water flooding; a food-price rise in 2027

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



51.59°N 0.14°W, United Kingdom · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** The danger is the ordinary winter, not a deep freeze: flu, RSV, and cold homes in Haringey's oldest corner, among people living alone in large, cold, solid-walled houses.
- **First action.** Muswell Hill GP practices and pharmacies give RSV vaccine to everyone over 75 who hasn't had it, and flu vaccine to housebound and lone over-65s, before December.*
- **The money.** £12k floor, £17k target, £27k ceiling; the best-value pound pays the caseworker who connects frail residents to about £1.58m of unallocated crisis-fund money and to Pension Credit.
- **Do not.** Do not commission rushed solid-wall insulation this autumn "to get ready for El Niño": it would do more harm than good.

What to do	**13** actions	p. 5
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Do not do this	**9** items	p. 19
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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

London Borough of Barnet			

22/22 recommendations checked. Of 14 proposed actions, 1 was confirmed, 12 were corrected (partially confirmed), and 1, a Warm Home Prescription, was contraindicated as written because no scheme pays winter energy bills on GP referral in Haringey. Of 8 proposed "do not" warnings, 3 were confirmed and 5 were narrowed. **Biggest corrections:**

- Since 1 September 2026, everyone 75 and over can have the RSV vaccine, not only the over-80s. That is about 1,170 people in the three census areas that make up most of N10.*
- Haringey's crisis fund is £5.93m a year. £4.36m of this year's money is committed, and about £1.58m is unallocated and delegated to one director. An alert-triggered energy payment needs one decision, not a new budget.
- Crisis-fund money can be held over within the fund's three years (to March 2029), so part of it can be planned for the 2027 food-price peak. Our N4 briefing of the same day said the opposite; this is the corrected reading.
- No meals-on-wheels service could be confirmed in Haringey. The provider the council once listed may no longer trade.

The funding target fell by more than a third, from £35k to £17k (floor £12k, ceiling £27k), after the Warm Home Prescription and a food-bank fuel-voucher line were dropped. **The El Niño premise was tested, not assumed,** from 43 winters of records at Hampstead, about 4 km away, carried over from the E17 Walthamstow briefing of 11 October. **Exposure figure:** Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review, publishes none for the UK. Population figures are for the three Census 2021 areas (MSOAs Haringey 014, 021, and 022) that make up most of N10; health figures are for the London Borough of Haringey.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Hampstead daily records, winters 1973–74 to 2015–16 (the record ends in July 2016), classed by the December–February Oceanic Niño Index. Heathrow's complete temperature record to 2024–25 was used as a cross-check. Only four or five winters were strong El Niños, so read every difference as a tilt, not a rule.

WINTERS	DEC–FEB MEAN (°C)	NIGHTS AT OR BELOW −3 °C, DEC–MAR	JAN–MAR DAYS WITH MEAN AT OR BELOW 0 °C	WINTERS WITH A 7-DAY RUN AT OR BELOW 0 °C	WINTERS WITH A 3-DAY RUN AT OR BELOW 2 °C	OCT–FEB RAIN (MM)
Strong El Niño (4)	5.6	3.3	2.0	0 of 4	3 of 4	281
Moderate or weak El Niño (11)	4.7	6.2	4.6	3 of 11	10 of 11	397
Neutral (13)	4.4	8.9	7.3	6 of 13	11 of 13	358
La Niña (15)	5.0	6.1	4.5	2 of 15	11 of 15	284

- **Strong El Niño winters here have been mild.** They were the warmest class and had the fewest frosts. None produced a 7-day freeze, which is the run that triggers the government's Cold Weather Payment (£25 a week, 1 November to 31 March). Heathrow tells the same story: 6.6 °C in strong winters, against 5.4 °C in neutral ones.
- **Short cold spells still came.** Three of the four strong winters had a spell of three days at or below 2 °C. Plan for short cold spells, not for a deep freeze.
- **The counter-example is 2009–10.** Its index sat at 1.47, just under the strong threshold. It averaged 2.6 °C, with 15 hard-frost nights and a 7-day freeze, so nobody should plan on a mild winter either.
- **What the Met Office says.** *"For the UK, El Niño increases the chances of a wetter and stormier late autumn and early winter period, which would also likely be milder than normal."* Later in winter there is *"an increased chance of Sudden Stratospheric Warming (SSW) events… increasing the potential for cold weather"* (Met Office blog, 23 September 2026).
- **A mild winter is not a safe one.** The public health lens reported that Haringey's excess winter deaths followed the flu season, not El Niño: an ordinary year in the strong 2015–16 event and the peaks in flu-heavy winters. Those figures could not be re-checked (the Fingertips service

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

was unreachable and ONS has the series under review), so read this as a pattern, not a measurement. Haringey recorded about 350 excess winter deaths over the five winters to 2020. On the order of 70 a year across a borough of 260,000 means that no result in N10 alone will be statistically visible. Judge the work by uptake and contact, not by deaths counted.

EXPOSURE, HONESTLY

WHO IS AT RISK, AND WHERE

- **The oldest corner of a young borough.** The three census areas covering most of N10 had 18,405 residents in 2021. 13.3%, 16.7%, and 17.8% were 65 or over (851, 1,096, and 967 people), against 10.5% for Haringey and 11.9% for London. 634 were 80 or over and about 1,170 were 75 or over.
- **Many live alone.** 821 households are one person aged 66 or over (227, 361, and 233). In Haringey 021 that is 12.6% of households, against 8.5% borough-wide. Haringey's 2025 older people's needs assessment names Muswell Hill, Fortis Green, and Crouch End as the borough's highest concentrations of older people living alone.
- **Flu uptake is low for an older, wealthier area.** 56.2% of Haringey's over-65s were vaccinated in 2025/26 (22,126 of 39,337), against 65.0% in Barnet and 74.5% for England. No N10 figure exists. Uptake is probably higher here than in east Haringey, but that is an inference.
- **Two care homes for older people sit in N10.** Spring Lane, 170 Fortis Green (63 places), is one. The Meadow, run by MHA on Meadow Drive (40 beds), is the other. Both are rated Good by the Care Quality Commission.
- **The houses carry the cold.** 57–68% of households own their home and about a third rent privately, mostly in Victorian and Edwardian houses and the flats converted from them. Most of the area is in conservation areas. Awaab's Law, which sets repair deadlines for cold and damp, covers social housing, so it reaches few homes here.
- **Means-tested help passes the area by.** The home a pensioner lives in does not count against Pension Credit. An opposition council motion, citing Policy in Practice, put unclaimed Pension Credit across Haringey at almost £17m a year and more than 4,000 households. People in large houses on a state pension are the ones least likely to claim.
- **No Age UK covers the Haringey side.** Age UK Haringey closed in 2016. Age UK Barnet runs services, and Barnet's crisis fund, on the Barnet strip.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

HOW FOOD REACHES MUSWELL HILL

SUPPLY CHAIN

The honest finding is that El Niño's food signal here is weak and late. The risk is the last mile to housebound people and the household budget, not supply.

- **London will not run short of food; the risk is price.** UK food inflation was 1.3% in August 2026 (ONS; September figures due 21 October). The Food and Drink Federation forecasts 3.9% by December and a peak of 6.4% in July 2027; IGD expects 5.6–6.6% on average through 2027. The war with Iran and energy costs drive this as much as El Niño does. The exposed imports are sugar, cocoa, coffee, and rice.
- **The chain breaks at the front door.** In 2017 Haringey consulted on ending its meals-on-wheels subsidy, by then used by about 110 people a month. The outcome was not found. The private provider the council's leaflet lists stopped taking new referrals in 2020, and its websites no longer resolve. No hot-meal delivery service could be confirmed for N10 today.
- **One food bank, by referral.** Muswell Hill Foodbank (Trussell, charity 1139475) runs at Wilton Community Church, N10 1LT, on Monday, Wednesday, and Friday from 11:30 to 13:30, with three-day parcels on a voucher. It does not deliver. The Muswell Hill Churches Soup Kitchen at Muswell Hill Baptist Church serves takeaway meals on Thursdays and Sundays.
- **Children: the gain is at secondary school.** From September 2026 every child in a Universal Credit household in England qualifies for free school meals; Haringey estimates over 17,000 children aged 5 to 15. Primary pupils in London already get free meals through the Mayor's scheme, so the new gain is for secondary pupils, and some families must reapply. Haringey's holiday food vouchers were extended to September 2026, with "a more targeted approach" to follow.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED BY LIVES PER EFFORT

The first five actions carry nearly all the expected deaths this winter: they reach the oldest and most isolated residents before December. Actions 6 to 9 cover the hazards that recur on the hill: water, warmth, and food for the housebound. Actions 10 and 11 prepare for the 2027

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

food-price peak. Actions 12 and 13 are low-cost hazard measures for storms and heavy rain.

1. RSV vaccination for everyone over 75 who hasn't had it, and flu vaccination for housebound and lone over-65s, before December *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Muswell Hill GP practices and primary care network, under NHS North Central London; pharmacies. Volunteers at warm sessions and on doorsteps book jabs and go along	Lists by 31 October; jabs by early December	Vaccines NHS-funded; volunteer time	RSV and flu admissions and deaths among the oldest residents

Everyone 80 and over, and care-home residents, became eligible for RSV vaccine on 1 April 2026. From 1 September 2026 eligibility was widened to everyone 75 and over, with no upper age limit, and to 65–74s with chronic respiratory disease or a weakened immune system. It is one dose. That is about 1,170 people over 75 in the three census areas, so a list-based catch-up is realistic: take the 75–79s and the over-80s together, not in sequence. A UKHSA test-negative study in 14 hospitals in 2024/25 found the vaccine about 82% effective against hospital admission at ages 75–79. Pair it with flu vaccination for housebound and lone over-65s. Lead every conversation with the jab, not with energy efficiency.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the lens proposed "80+ first, then 75–79"; both groups are now eligible. National RSV coverage among eligible older adults is 61.9% (48.5% in the most deprived tenth), not the 64.8% a lens cited. The 82% figure covers hospital admission at 75–79, not deaths, and is a UKHSA release, not a peer-reviewed paper. For flu, Anderson, Dobkin, and Gorry (2020) found no fall in deaths at England's age-65 eligibility cut-off, so the effect on deaths is uncertain; prioritise the frail.

2. Flu vaccination for staff at Spring Lane and The Meadow care homes by mid-November, and an RSV check for every resident

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Spring Lane and MHA The Meadow managers; NHS North Central London	Mid-November	Free NHS flu vaccine for frontline social-care staff	Deaths among about 100 care-home residents

A 2025 Cochrane review of randomised trials (Thomas et al., four trials, 8,468 residents) found that vaccinating care-home staff cut residents' all-cause deaths (risk ratio 0.69, 95% CI 0.60 to 0.80), at moderate certainty. Hayward et al. (BMJ 2006), a cluster trial in 44 UK homes, is one of the pooled trials. Care-home residents of any age are now eligible for RSV vaccine, so check that every resident has had it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the review's authors note that influenza cases and respiratory admissions did not fall, so the drop in deaths "could not be explained" and the mechanism is uncertain. The figure of 5 fewer deaths per 100 residents attributed to Hayward was not re-checked. Expect roughly 0 to 3 deaths averted here in a moderate season, and none in a mild one.

3. Get Pension Credit claims in before mid-December: do the calculation at the door, and say plainly that the house doesn't count

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey Citizens Advice Bureaux (Haringey Advice Partnership, sessions at Muswell Hill Family Hub); Age UK Barnet on the Barnet strip	Claims in by mid-December	£10k winter caseworker (see funding)	Older people going without the payments that pay for heat

Pension Credit backdates up to three months. The home a claimant lives in is disregarded, unless part of it could be sold separately or equity has been released; the first £10,000 of savings is ignored. A successful claim brings the Cold Weather Payment and Council Tax Reduction, and usually the £150 Warm Home Discount, whose scheme reopens this October. Leaflets that say "you may be entitled" don't move people who think they are too well-off to claim; a caseworker or trained volunteer working through the numbers with them does. Book Attendance Allowance claims at the same visit.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the Winter Fuel Payment is no longer tied to Pension Credit (it is paid to people born on or before 27 June 1960 and clawed back above £35,000 of individual income), so the December urgency rests on the Cold Weather Payment and the Warm Home Discount. The £17m unclaimed figure comes from an opposition council motion, not a council estimate. The caseworker cost is a planning estimate.

4. Haringey adds one rule to its crisis fund: a UKHSA amber cold-health alert releases an energy payment to older households it already knows, with no application

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · LEGAL, NOT YET ADOPTED | ECONOMIST · EMERGENCY MGR | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey Council, through the Corporate Director who holds the unallocated crisis-fund money; Age UK Barnet for the Barnet strip	**Decision by 30 November**	**£100 per household paid (arithmetic; no household count sourced), from the existing fund**	**Older people rationing heat in a short cold spell that the Cold Weather Payment won't cover**

Haringey's Crisis and Resilience Fund is £5,932,161 a year to 2029. £4,356,829 of this year's money is committed across decisions on 24 March and 10 July, including £550,000 of cash crisis payments; about £1,575,332 is unallocated and delegated. The DWP guidance allows payments for energy costs and proactive, data-targeted payments, though it says crisis payments are "primarily on an application-basis" and discourages blanket payments. A payment to older households already on council tax support, released by an amber alert, fits both. The Cold Weather Payment needs seven days at or below 0 °C, which no strong El Niño winter at Hampstead produced. On the Barnet side, refer over-55s facing a sudden shock, such as a boiler failure, to Age UK Barnet's crisis fund (savings under £2,000).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: amber alerts are no longer set by a temperature threshold; since June 2023 UKHSA and the Met Office use a matrix of impact and likelihood, from 1 November to 31 March. Haringey has adopted no such rule, and its full crisis-fund policy goes to Cabinet later this financial year. Barnet's scheme is marked "provisional" and publishes no payment amounts.

5. A cold-spell phone round, run by neighbours who are asked to "keep an eye on someone", and Priority Services Register sign-up for everyone on it

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Church congregations, street WhatsApp groups (many grew from the 2020 Muswell Hill Community Support lists), and the Hilldene hub for Keynes Close and Clissold Close sheltered housing	Lists by 30 November; calls on day 1 and day 3 of every amber alert	Volunteer time	An older person alone in a cold house going unnoticed

The frontline lens's advice: the people at risk here won't accept "help", but they will agree to keep an eye on a neighbour. Once they are on the round as helpers, they are being checked on too. Each caller rings about five people. At the first call, sign everyone up to the Priority Services Registers of UK Power Networks, Thames Water, and their energy supplier, which is free and brings priority contact in outages and a free annual gas safety check for eligible customers. Keep the round going for about a week after a thaw, when burst mains cut water (action 6).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no study shows that phone or visit checks reduce cold deaths; NICE's 2015 guideline (NG6) found "relatively few studies", and its research question on this is still open. The case rests on low cost and on reaching people. The "week after the thaw" is a judgement, not a measured window.

6. Agree a water-outage plan for N10 with Thames Water before the frosts: shared vulnerable lists, a bottled-water point on the hill, and doorstep delivery to sheltered housing and care homes

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ALL-SEASON | EMERGENCY MGR | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey Emergency Planning with Thames Water	30 November	Staff time	Frail residents going without water for a day or more after a burst

The hill loses water first. In November 2003 a 16-inch main burst at Woodside Avenue and cut supply to N6, N8, N10, and parts of N22 for about 24 hours. In July 2007 a 24-inch main burst at the Alexandra Palace pumping station and flooded homes in Redston Road. In October 2016 a burst on Muswell Hill Road flooded six basements. Nationally, after the 2018 "Beast from the East", more than 200,000 customers lost water for over four hours and 60,000 for over twelve, mostly as the thaw arrived; Ofwat named Thames Water among the poor performers and ordered it to fix its failings.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the 2003 and 2007 accounts come from a local councillor's blog and the 2016 one from a fire brigade incident record now offline, not from Thames Water. There was no fine in 2018; Thames paid voluntary compensation of £30 to £150. That Haringey and Barnet households were without water "for days" in December 2022 rests on one secondary report. Bursts cluster in the days after a thaw; no source supports a precise "2 to 5 days".

7. Ask for the warm sessions to open from 1 November, and use them as the place where jabs are booked and Pension Credit is checked

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey Communities team; St James Church, Alexandra Park Library, and Muswell Hill Library; Muswell Hill Methodist Church	Ask now; open 1 November	Near zero at libraries open anyway; volunteers	An October and November gap in the season that flu, RSV, and storms don't observe

Haringey's Warm Welcome season ran from early October to the end of March in 2024–25, at St James Church and Alexandra Park Library. In 2025–26 it ran only from the end of November to early March; Muswell Hill Library, reopened in September 2025, was a venue. No 2026–27 dates are published. Put a volunteer at each session who books jabs (action 1) and starts Pension Credit claims (action 3).

Corrections: "from 1 November" is a request to Haringey, not a confirmed start. A Thursday drop-in at Muswell Hill Methodist was reported by a lens but not confirmed. Warm spaces are an access point, not the cold measure (see "Do not do this").

8. Find every housebound older person in N10 who needs a hot meal, and how they will get one, by 30 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · PROVISION UNCONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey adult social care, with the GP practices, churches, and the phone round (action 5)	30 November	Staff time; meals at cost to the resident unless funded	Housebound people going without food in cold spells and the flu season

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

No council-subsidised meals-on-wheels service could be confirmed. Before referring anyone to the provider on the council's old leaflet, check it still trades. For people who won't go to a food bank, trained volunteers can deliver food-bank parcels quietly to the door.

Corrections: the outcome of the 2017 decision on the subsidy was not found. The provider's websites no longer resolve, so it may have closed.

9. In tall houses: heat the rooms you use, including the bedroom before bed, to about 18 °C; make the stairs safe; get the gas fire checked; and fit a carbon monoxide alarm *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: LOOSE ONLY (WEATHERISATION, GERMANY 2024)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Residents and families; volunteers on the phone round; energy suppliers (free gas safety check for Priority Services Register customers)	Before the first cold spell	An alarm costs about £20; the gas check is free to eligible customers	Cold bedrooms, falls on cold stairs, and carbon monoxide poisoning from old gas fires

UKHSA advises heating the rooms you spend a lot of time in, such as the living room or bedroom, to at least 18 °C. Older people who heat one room in a tall house end up sleeping downstairs or climbing cold stairs at night. Remove trip hazards, add lighting and rails, and service any gas fire.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the 18 °C minimum comes from WHO (2018) and NICE guidance, not from a trial of bedroom heating. Home-hazard changes reduce falls in high-risk older people, but no source links them to cold-weather deaths. Carbon monoxide alarms are legally required in rented homes with a fixed combustion appliance (since October 2022), not in owner-occupied homes, which are most homes here.

10. Sign up newly eligible secondary pupils for free school meals before the January census, and set holiday food rules for 2027 that reach the July peak

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey Council and secondary schools; the crisis-fund team for holiday food	Sign-ups November to January; holiday rules by January	Staff time; holiday food from the crisis fund	Children's diets being squeezed at the 2027 price peak

Universal Credit households "will automatically qualify", in the council's words, but some families "may need to reapply", and schools must recheck eligibility every year. Because crisis-fund money can be held within the fund's three years, Haringey can plan Easter and summer 2027 holiday food now; it has already delegated year-two money for Easter 2027.

Corrections: primary pupils already get free meals under the Mayor's scheme, so the gain is at secondary school. The holiday-voucher extension to September 2026 rests on local press, not the decision notice.

11. Watch two monthly price series, and give the food bank cash that rises with food prices from early 2027

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey crisis-fund team and local funders; Muswell Hill Foodbank	Watch from now; grants from January 2027	About 6% on top of existing grants (planning assumption)	Parcels shrinking as prices rise, because food banks buy at shop prices too

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Triggers: ONS consumer price inflation for food at 5% or more (monthly; next release 21 October), and the FAO All Rice Price Index up 10% or more in three months, or any Indian rice export restriction (monthly; next release 6 November). A third, the food bank's own parcel count, is not published and needs a data-sharing agreement. For households, cash routes (actions 3 and 4) beat more parcels; the food bank is the backstop.

Corrections: the forecasts come from trade-press reports of the FDF and IGD releases. IGD's 5.6–6.6% is an average for 2027, not a peak. No volume figures for the food bank were found.

12. Clear the gullies on Park Road (North), at Etheldene Avenue and Cranley Gardens, before mid-November, and report blocked drains on the slopes

CONFIRMED · ALL-SEASON | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MGR | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey Highways; residents report blockages	Mid-November	Existing gully programme	Surface-water flooding into basements in a wetter, stormier late autumn

In the floods of 12 and 25 July 2021, Park Road (North) flooded at Etheldene Avenue and Cranley Gardens, on the N10 edge, with blocked gullies and residents clearing drains themselves (Section 19 flood investigation, January 2022). The report's first recommendation was to prioritise gully cleaning in surface-water risk areas. The council cleans all gullies every two years and critical drainage areas every year.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the report does not mention a collapsed sewer, and most of Priory Road is in N8, so it was dropped. Heavy rain on N10's paved front gardens runs downhill: the Moselle rises in Queen's Wood and runs underground to Tottenham, where a 1906 account said that "any exceptional downpour in the Muswell Hill district always causes trouble". That history was reported by a lens and not re-checked.

13. Ask the owners to inspect roadside trees along Muswell Hill Road before December, and stay away from the wood edges on Met Office amber wind days

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Haringey (Queen's Wood and street trees) and the City of London (Highgate Wood)	Inspections before December; wind-day advice now	Existing tree budgets; advice costs nothing	A repeat of the 2022 storm death

At 16:03 on 18 February 2022, during Storm Eunice, a tree fell on a car on Muswell Hill Road and killed a woman, the first death from the storm in England. The Met Office expects a stormier late autumn and early winter this year.

Corrections: the sources place the tree "near South Close", not at Highgate Wood, so who owned it is unconfirmed. No published inspection programme was found for either wood; ask the owners rather than assume one exists.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	NHS NCL, GPs & pharmacies	Care homes	Citizens Advice Haringey	Age UK Barnet	Haringey crisis fund & welfare	Haringey adult social care	Churches, libraries & volunteers	Thames Water & UKPN	Haringey Emergency Planning & Highways	City of London	Schools & food bank
1. RSV for over-75s; flu for housebound	**A/R**			**C**		**C**	**R**				
2. Care-home staff flu; resident RSV	**R**	**A/R**				**C**					
3. Pension Credit claims at the door			**A/R**	**R**	**C**		**R**				
4. Alert-triggered energy payment			**C**	**R**	**A/R**	**C**			**I**		
5. Cold-spell phone round; registers	**I**			**C**		**C**	**A/R**	**C**			
6. Water-outage plan		**C**				**C**	**I**	**R**	**A/R**		
7. Warm sessions from 1 November	**C**		**R**		**A/R**		**R**				
8. Hot meals for the housebound	**C**					**A/R**	**R**				**C**
9. Warm bedroom, safe stairs, gas check, CO alarm	**I**			**C**			**A/R**	**R**			
10. Free school meals; 2027 holiday food					**A/R**						**R**
11. Price triggers; cash to the food bank					**A/R**		**C**				**R**
12. Gullies at Park Road (North)							**I**		**A/R**		
13. Tree checks; wind-day advice							**I**		**A/R**	**R**	

What the chart shows: **Haringey's crisis-fund and welfare team is accountable for four rows**, and three of them (the alert rule, the warm-session dates, and the 2027 holiday plan) need a decision, not new money. **Volunteers and churches are accountable for two rows and do the work in six**: in an area with no Age UK on the Haringey side, they are the delivery capacity. The NHS owns the two rows that carry most of the expected lives saved.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

Verified and corrected. The council already holds about £1.58m of unallocated crisis-fund money this year. The best-value private pound pays for the caseworker who connects frail residents to that money and to Pension Credit, not for heat itself. Before giving anything, ask Haringey whether its crisis fund's community-advice workstream already pays for this casework.

FLOOR

£12k

TARGET

£17k (down from a proposed £35k)

CEILING

£27k

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Whether Haringey's crisis fund already pays for advice casework in

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

N10; if it does, the floor falls to £2k

Arithmetic. Floor: Citizens Advice Haringey winter caseworker £10,000 (13 weeks × a loaded £40,000 a year) + Muswell Hill Churches Soup Kitchen extra cold-spell sessions £2,000 = **£12,000**. Target: floor + Age UK Barnet winter home checks £5,000 (about 165 checks at £30), released only if the service is confirmed unfunded = **£17,000**. Ceiling: target + a second 13-week caseworker term to March, £10,000 = **£27,000**. Above that, absorptive capacity binds: N10 has about 1,170 people over 75 and 821 lone older households, and a second caseworker runs out of new households. The caseworker cost and the soup-kitchen line are planning assumptions, not published unit costs. No published cost per death averted exists for any placement in this setting, so the ranking rests on mechanism. The proposed target fell 51% after verification removed two placements.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Haringey Citizens Advice Bureaux (charity 1069301)	Action 3: Pension Credit, Attendance Allowance, and crisis-fund casework for over-75s in N10	£10k	Direct grant	Income £980k in 2024/25, £811k of it government grants; a £10k post is well within its scale. Check it is not already funded by the crisis fund's advice workstream	Partially confirmed
Muswell Hill Churches Soup Kitchen (Muswell Hill Baptist Church, N10 2PT)	Action 5: extra hot-meal sessions in cold spells	£2k	Contingency, released on an amber cold-health alert	Takeaway sessions Thursday and Sunday; it serves homeless and vulnerable adults rather than older people at home. Income unverified	Partially confirmed
Age UK Barnet	Actions 1 and 9: winter home checks and jab prompts on the Barnet strip	£5k	Conditional grant	The service page is live (£30 a check, free for concessions), so it may not need restarting. Release only if Age UK Barnet confirms it is unfunded	Unverified

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Warm Home Prescription (proposed via SHINE London or Fuel Bank Foundation)	Winter energy bills for GP-referred COPD and heart-failure patients	£0	Dropped	No scheme pays bills on GP referral in Haringey. The SGN–Fuel Bank phase covered Scotland and the south, ran December 2024 to March 2026, and is full; SHINE refers but does not pay bills	Contraindicated as written
Muswell Hill Foodbank	Fuel vouchers on an amber alert	£0	Dropped	The food bank issues no fuel vouchers. Fuel Bank Foundation's Haringey partner is Tottenham Foodbank, and its vouchers are for prepayment meters, which few households here use	Contraindicated

The funder's one thing: Haringey has £1.58m of unallocated crisis money that it can hold within the fund's three years, but no older people's charity on the Haringey side of N10 to steer it to residents. The cheapest life saved here is the frail pensioner in a big house who is helped to claim what they are owed and gets an RSV jab, not one who gets a parallel grant.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives, money, or trust here.

Do not commission rushed solid-wall insulation this autumn "to get ready for El Niño"

CONTRAINDICATED (NARROWED) SKEPTIC

The National Audit Office (October 2025) found that about 98% of homes given external wall insulation under the government's ECO4 and GBIS schemes, some 22,000 to 23,000 homes, had major problems, with up to 2,000 posing an immediate health and safety risk; so did 29% of internal installs. Solid, pre-1920 walls were the problem housing type, which describes much of N10. ECO4 stopped taking new

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applications on 31 March 2026 (it runs to 31 December only to finish work), so new jobs here will be private, with less oversight. In a conservation area, cladding the outside of a house needs planning permission, but internal wall insulation does not, so the riskier option is the one that goes unchecked by planning. Building Regulations still apply.

Instead: repair gutters, pointing, and render; insulate the loft and draught-proof now; and get a moisture assessment before any wall insulation, later.

Do not tell older people to heat just one room or move their bed downstairs*

`CONTRAINDICATED (NARROWED)` `SKEPTIC; CONFLICTS WITH OFFICIAL ADVICE`

UKHSA and the NHS advise heating the rooms you use regularly, including the bedroom, to at least 18 °C. No trial supports heating one room instead. In tall houses it means cold bedrooms or cold stairs at night.

Instead: heat the bedroom before bed and make the stairs safe (action 9).

Do not wait for the Cold Weather Payment, or for an application, before money moves

`CONTRAINDICATED` `ECONOMIST · EMERGENCY MGR`

The Cold Weather Payment pays £25 for seven consecutive days at or below 0 °C (recorded or forecast), from 1 November 2026 to 31 March 2027, and only to people on certain benefits. None of the four strong El Niño winters in the Hampstead record produced one.

Instead: Pension Credit claims (action 3) and an alert-triggered payment (action 4).

Do not count on energy suppliers or smart meters to notice someone rationing heat

`CONTRAINDICATED (NARROWED)` `SKEPTIC`

Ofgem's licence duty on this mainly covers prepayment customers who cut themselves off, and suppliers told Ofgem that rationing is hard to detect. Most homes here pay by direct debit, so nobody sees the thermostat turned down. The evidence dates from 2020.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: a neighbour on the phone round checks in person (action 5).

Do not treat warm spaces as the cold measure, or count visitors as success

`CONTRAINDICATED` `SKEPTIC`

UKHSA's evidence review calls itself a first step towards generating evidence, and Gateshead's evaluation found the evidence limited. Visitor counts don't show that anyone at risk was protected.

Instead: use the sessions to book jabs and start claims (action 7), and measure who on the lists was reached.

Do not stand the cold response down on the day of the thaw

`CONTRAINDICATED (NARROWED)` `EMERGENCY MGR`

Pipes and mains burst as the ice melts. After the 2018 cold spell, supply losses peaked as the thaw arrived, and N10's hill has a long record of bursts.

Instead: keep the phone round and the water plan running for about a week after a thaw (actions 5 and 6).

Do not burn wood on still, cold days

`CONTRAINDICATED (NARROWED)` `HISTORIAN`

All of Haringey is a smoke control area: wood may be burned only in a Defra-approved stove. In London, wood-smoke markers peak at low temperatures, and in winter wood burning can rival traffic as a source of fine particles (Crilley et al., 2015). Older people with heart and lung disease breathe it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: on still, cold days, heat with the boiler. The Barnet strip's smoke control status was not checked.

Do not stockpile food this autumn as the El Niño response

CONTRAINDICATED FOOD SUPPLY; VERIFICATION

Food inflation was 1.3% in August 2026, and the forecast peak is around mid-2027. Stock bought in November is eaten long before the peak.

Instead: plan 2027 holiday food and price triggers now (actions 10 and 11).

Do not plan on a Warm Home Prescription here this winter

CONTRAINDICATED AS WRITTEN PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST; FAILED VERIFICATION

The evaluated scheme averaged about £1,000 a patient across 823 patients in 2022–23 (Sheffield Hallam; not peer-reviewed, with no measure of deaths). But no route pays winter bills on GP referral in Haringey: the latest phase covered Scotland and the south of England and is full, and Haringey's partner, SHINE, refers rather than pays. Money set aside for it would sit unspent.

Instead: an alert-triggered energy payment from the crisis fund (action 4).

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1873	Alexandra Palace burns 16 days after opening	Three staff killed	Rebuilt and reopened in 1875
1952 (December)	The Great Smog, London-wide	About 4,000 deaths by the official count; no Hornsey figure	Clean Air Act 1956; Hornsey's first smoke control orders only from 1 September 1960

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1982–83, 1997–98, 2015–16	Strong El Niño winters	No local incident found. Mild winters with little frost at Hampstead	—
2003 (November)	16-inch main bursts at Woodside Avenue	N6, N8, N10, and parts of N22 without water for about 24 hours	Thames Water criticised as slow
2007 (26 July)	24-inch main bursts at the Alexandra Palace pumping station	Homes flooded in Redston Road	—
2016 (October)	Burst main on Muswell Hill Road	Six basements flooded; about 10 people evacuated	—
2018 (March)	"Beast from the East" and thaw	Nationally, 200,000+ customers without water for over 4 hours	Ofwat orders Thames Water to fix its failings
2021 (12 and 25 July)	Flash floods	Park Road (North) floods at Etheldene Avenue and Cranley Gardens	Section 19 investigation; gully cleaning prioritised
2022 (18 February)	Storm Eunice	A woman killed by a falling tree on Muswell Hill Road	No inspection programme found
2025–26	Warm Welcome season shortened to late November – early March	—	No 2026–27 dates published
2026	Crisis and Resilience Fund replaces the Household Support Fund (April); RSV vaccine widened to all over-75s (September)	About £1.58m of Haringey's year-one fund unallocated	—

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the hill's water mains fail in the thaw, not the freeze, and N10's cold-weather help has always stood down when the cold breaks. The 2003, 2007, and 2016 bursts here, and the national thaws of 2018 and 2022, all left people without water after the cold had passed. A second recurrence runs downhill: rain that N10's paved gardens and blocked drains shed reaches Tottenham through the buried Moselle, as a 1906 account already complained.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — RESOLVED AND OPEN

- **Resolved: how big is the crisis fund?** One lens said £5.93m, another £4.36m. Both were right: £5.93m is the annual allocation and £4.36m is the part of this year's money already committed.
- **Resolved: can crisis money be held for 2027?** A lens and our N4 briefing said no; the DWP guidance recovers only underspend at the end of the fund's third year, so money can be planned across years to March 2029.
- **Open: does the flu catch-up save lives?** Anderson 2020 found no fall in deaths at the age-65 cut-off. RSV and flu stay first because uptake is low and the new RSV eligibility reaches the over-75s, but the effect on deaths is stated as uncertain.
- **Open: retrofit or not?** The skeptic argued that the danger in N10 is the paid-for retrofit, not neglect. No lens argued for insulating walls this winter; the disagreement is about how hard to warn. The warning is kept, narrowed to rushed solid-wall jobs.
- **Resolved: Warm Home Prescription.** Two lenses proposed it; verification found no route that pays bills here, so it moved to "Do not do this".

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Private renters in converted flats, and the Barnet strip. About a third of households rent privately, mostly in conversions, outside Awaab's Law and outside any landlord's vulnerability list. They move often, so no list here finds them. The western strip of N10 is in Barnet, with a different council, crisis fund, and smoke-control regime, and it was researched far less than the Haringey side. No local count of winter deaths, malnutrition, or isolation exists to show whether any of these actions worked.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and

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feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; cold, flu, food prices, and flooding are additional to it and are carried here by the station record, the historical record, and the supply-chain evidence rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request was for a full postcode in Muswell Hill, which covers a few homes. The briefing was built for the N10 postcode district (Muswell Hill and Fortis Green), using the three Census 2021 areas that make up most of it: MSOAs Haringey 014 (E02000410), 021 (E02000417), and 022 (E02000418). Climate Impact Lab impact region: the region containing the London Borough of Haringey, name not resolved. Health figures are borough-level. Sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Premise test.** Carried from the E17 Walthamstow briefing (11 October 2026): NOAA station data for Hampstead (UKE00105915), about 4 km from Muswell Hill, and Heathrow (UKM00003772), classed by the CPC Oceanic Niño Index.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. Each was pointed to the national facts in the N4 briefing of the same day and asked to research only what is local.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted. Contradictions were kept. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked the health actions, the financial actions, the operational actions, the food actions, the funding envelope, and the contraindicated items, on evidence, transferability, and feasibility. They fetched Nomis, UKHSA's 2025/26 flu uptake data, GOV.UK guidance on RSV, Pension Credit, the Cold Weather Payment, the Winter Fuel Payment, and the Crisis and Resilience Fund, the Cochrane review, CQC listings, Haringey's crisis-fund decision report and Section 19 flood report, Ofwat's 2018 freeze-thaw review, the

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NAO's 2025 report, and Ofgem guidance directly. Financial actions were checked for availability, payer, trigger, and redundancy. The envelope was re-summed.

- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Read through its data interface (96 entries) during verification. None is from the UK, and none covers vaccination, welfare payments, water outages, or food access. The nearest entries were weatherisation upgrades (Germany, 2024) and a cold-weather alert programme (Canada, 2019). Those findings are carried into the tags.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (vaccine eligibility, heating the home and carbon monoxide, and cold-home advice for older people) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so. Every source is listed below.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in N10 was interviewed. Not reachable: the Fingertips public health service (so the excess-winter-death series and 2024/25 flu figures were not re-checked), parts of Haringey's website (403), the Charity Commission register (403 and 504), and a fire brigade incident page (404). Not confirmed: current meals-on-wheels provision, 2026–27 warm-space dates, a Thursday drop-in at Muswell Hill Methodist, the owner of the tree that fell in 2022, the Barnet strip's smoke-control status, and whether Fortis Green lies in the ancient parish of Hornsey, which bounds Hornsey Parochial Charities' grants.

References · verified in this briefing unless marked.
Premise (carried from the E17 briefing): CPC Oceanic Niño Index · GHCN-D Hampstead · GHCN-D Heathrow · Met Office blog, 23 Sep 2026 · Cold Weather Payment · Haringey Affordable Energy Strategy 2020 (lens; not re-fetched)
Population and health: Nomis TS007A, three MSOAs · Haringey older people's needs assessment 2025 (lens) · UKHSA flu uptake 2025/26 · RSV eligibility expansion · RSV effectiveness, UKHSA · RSV coverage · Cochrane 2025, staff vaccination · CQC, The Meadow · CQC, Spring Lane · UKHSA, keep warm, keep well · NICE NG6 research recommendation · Cold-health alerting system · North Central London flu uptake (lens)
Money: Haringey crisis fund decision report · Interim allocation principles · DWP crisis fund guidance · Pension Credit, claiming · Pension Credit adviser guide · Pension Credit, what you get · Warm Home Discount · Winter Fuel Payment · Council motion on unclaimed Pension Credit · Age UK Barnet crisis fund · Age UK Barnet winter home checks · Haringey Citizens Advice Bureaux · Muswell Hill Churches Soup Kitchen · Warm Home

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Prescription evaluation · SGN Warm Home Prescription · Haringey home heat loss grants · Ofgem prepayment rules · Citizens Advice on self-rationing

Housing and operations: NAO, Oct 2025 · ECO4 delivery guidance, Mar 2026 · Haringey Article 4 directions · Haringey smoke control · Crilley et al. 2015, wood smoke in London · Warm spaces evidence review · Gateshead warm spaces evaluation · Warm Welcome 2024–25, Muswell Hill · Woodside Avenue burst, 2003 (councillor's blog) · Alexandra Palace burst, 2007 (councillor's blog) · Ofwat freeze-thaw review · Thames Water letter to Ofwat, 2023 · Section 19 flood investigation, Hornsey and Crouch End · Storm Eunice death, LFB · Moselle history (lens; not re-fetched)

Food supply chain: ONS consumer price inflation, Aug 2026 · FAO rice price update · FDF forecast (trade press) · IGD forecast (trade press) · Muswell Hill Foodbank · Meals on wheels consultation, 2017 · Haringey free school meals · Free school meals for 17,000 children · Holiday vouchers extended (local press)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 12 October 2026 for Muswell Hill and Fortis Green, London N10. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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